

Israa Hashem

CONTACT INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics , Concordia University	2027 (expected)
Dissertation <i>Essays on the Economics of Education and Market Design</i>	
Supervisors: Gabrielle Vasey and Szilvia Pápai	
Parental leave: May 2024 – Dec 2024; May 2025 – Aug 2025	
M.A. in Applied Economics (High Distinction), Lebanese American University	2018 – 2020
B.Sc. in Mathematics (Distinction), Lebanese American University	2014 – 2018
Teaching Diploma , Lebanese American University	2017 – 2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics
Secondary: Market Design

JOB MARKET PAPER

Does Having an Older Sister Matter? Sibling Sex, School Achievement, and Parental Investment

Siblings share much of childhood, yet we know far less about how they shape each other's learning than about the role of parents, schools, or peers. I study whether having an older sister rather than an older brother affects second-born children's school achievement and how parents invest in their schooling. Using British Columbia school records linked to the Census to identify siblings, and exploiting the as-good-as-random sex of the first-born, I examine second-borns' Foundation Skills Assessment scores in reading, writing and numeracy in Grades 4 and 7, as well as their enrollment in French immersion. I also compare second-borns with their first-born siblings to ask whether having an older sister offsets part of the birth-order gap in achievement. Results are pending Statistics Canada disclosure review.

WORKING PAPERS

Intergenerational Educational Mobility and Field-of-Study Choice in Immigrant and Canadian-Born Families

Immigrant parents in Canada are highly educated and concentrated in STEM fields, but do their children follow the same paths? Using the Survey of Labour and Income Dynamics, I find strong persistence in degree attainment across generations, but weaker persistence for children of immigrant fathers, pointing to higher educational mobility among second-generation immigrants. First-generation immigrants sort clearly into STEM, yet this sorting does not carry over to the second generation, whose degree choices converge with those of the Canadian-born. These findings have implications for how immigration shapes Canada's skill composition over time.

When Does a Stable and Pareto-Efficient Matching Exist?

with Szilvia Pápai

We study when stability and Pareto efficiency are compatible in matching markets, a question that arises naturally in school choice and other priority-based allocation problems. Even the student-optimal stable matching may leave large welfare improvements available to students. We develop constructive procedures that use preferences and priorities to determine exactly when a stable and Pareto-efficient matching exists, and identify when the outcome of a deferred-acceptance-type procedure is already Pareto efficient for the students.

PUBLICATIONS

(2023) “Polluting Resource Extraction and Climate Risk” with Walid Marrouch. *Natural Resource Modeling*, 36(1): e12354.

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

18th Meeting of the Society for Social Choice and Welfare, University of Tokyo, Tokyo, Japan “When Does a Stable and Pareto-Efficient Matching Exist?”	2026
20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students’ Conference, CIRANO, Montréal, Canada “Intergenerational Educational Mobility and Field-of-Study Choice in Immigrant and Canadian-Born Families”	2026
CIREQ Interdisciplinary PhD Conference in Applied Market Design, Concordia University, Montréal, Canada “When Does a Stable and Pareto-Efficient Matching Exist?”	2026
Emergence Excellence Conference, Université du Québec à Montréal (UQAM), Montréal, Canada “Intergenerational Educational Mobility and Field-of-Study Choice in Immigrant and Canadian-Born Families”	2025
Economics Graduate Research Day, Concordia University, Montréal, Canada “Intergenerational Educational Mobility and Field-of-Study Choice in Immigrant and Canadian-Born Families”	2025

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Gabrielle Vasey, Concordia University Research on grade repetition in Pakistan using linked student, household, teacher, and school data; data cleaning and empirical analysis.	2025
Research Assistant, UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (ESCWA), Beirut Contributed to policy-oriented economic research through quantitative analysis, literature review, and preparation of research materials.	2019 - 2020
Research Assistant, Lebanese American University Supported applied economics research through data analysis, literature review, and preparation of research outputs.	2018 - 2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor, Concordia University	
ECON 302: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II	Winter 2027 (Upcoming)
ECON 301: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I	Winter 2026
Teaching Assistant, Concordia University	
ECON 421: Econometrics (tutorials)	Fall 2026
ECON 301: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I	Summer 2026
ECON 302: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II	Fall 2025
ECON 440: Economic Design	Fall 2025, Winter 2025, Fall 2022
ECON 326: Mathematics for Economists	Winter 2025, Fall 2023
ECON 695: Economic Design (Graduate)	Winter 2025, Winter 2022
ECON 491: Advanced Environmental Economics	Winter 2024
ECON 425: Advanced Mathematics for Economists	Winter 2023
ECON 437: Economics of Public Expenditure	Winter 2023
ECON 464: Game Theory	Summer 2022
ECON 201: Introduction to Microeconomics	Fall 2020 - Fall 2021

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

FRQSC Doctoral Scholarship, Fonds de Recherche du Québec – Société et Culture	2024 – 2026
First Prize, Economics Graduate Research Day, Concordia University	2025
FAS Graduate Fellowship, Concordia University	2020 – 2024
International Tuition Award of Excellence, Concordia University	2020 – 2024
Merit Scholarship, Concordia University	2020 – 2021
US MEPI Tomorrow's Leaders Graduate Scholarship	2018
Spirit of Service Award, Lebanese American University	2016
USAID University Scholarship Program (Full Scholarship)	2014

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Econometric Society Summer School in Dynamic Structural Econometrics: Market Design, MIT	2023
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SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Software: Stata, R, $\text{\LaTeX}$
Data: Confidential linked administrative microdata (BC student records, Census, T1FF);
longitudinal survey data (SLID); Statistics Canada Research Data Centre (RDC)
Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent), French (beginner)

REFERENCES

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